

12.3 Workshop: The Interlaced Monitor Effect

Remember the old PC monitors that doubled your electricity bills, fried your retinas and had very visibly interlaced pictures? Now you can recreate the effect on your current monitor—albeit without the power bills and burning retinas. We'll use ImageReady to create an animation of a command prompt as you would have seen on one of those old monitors. Once you've got the hang of it, you can use the interlaced effect to make images look as if they were shot from a security camera or are being displayed on an old TV screen as well.

We'll start with a new Web banner in ImageReady (File > New > [choose Web Banner from the Image Size menu]). Fill the Background layer with black.



Stage I: Setting Up

Use the Type Tool [T] to create a new type layer; type in the default DOS prompt—"C:\>". Choose a fluorescent green colour, and a very "system-looking" font like Fixedsys or OCRA Extended.

For the blinking cursor, we'll just create another type layer with the same colour and font, with the underscore (_) character.

Stage II: The Pattern

To get the interlaced effect, we'll create a new pattern, which we will then stick on top of the text to make it look like it is being displayed on an old monitor.